



00

Start here

Pilot pack guide

Thank you for trying Slow Money. This pack holds everything a family needs for its first two sessions: a **Kitchen Table** conversation about money over a meal, and a **Money Memories** interview between generations. The sheets are numbered in the order you will use them.

00 This guide

Read first.

01 Ground rules card

Keep it on the table at every session.

02 Kitchen Table host sheet

For whoever calls the first conversation.

03 Kitchen Table question cards

Cut out and use during the first conversation.

04 Money Memories interview sheet

For a younger family member to interview an elder, after the first Kitchen Table.

05 Chronicle pages

Start the family chronicle at the end of the first conversation.

06 Pilot feedback sheet

Fill in once you have tried both practices.

Where The Test fits

Before the first Kitchen Table. Each adult who wants to can take The Test privately, online. It takes about 20 minutes and has three parts: general financial knowledge, the money system, and the Family Ledger, which is about your household.

After Money Memories. Anyone who took it retakes the third part, the Family Ledger, and the family compares answers at a final Kitchen Table. Where your answers differ is more interesting than any score.

Scores are private. As the first ground rule says, nobody has to share numbers, and that includes these.

Printing

Everything prints on A4 in black and white. Print sheet 03 on card if you can. Print several copies of the second page of sheet 05, one for each future session.



Scan to take The Test



01

The Kitchen Table

Ground rules card

Cut along the dashed lines. Keep one card on the table; give the other to another household or keep it with the chronicle.

Slow Money · The Kitchen Table

Our ground rules



1. Nobody has to share numbers.
2. Gifts stay gifts.
3. Every age speaks. The youngest may ask anything; the oldest speaks first about the past.
4. What is said here stays here.
5. We stop when it stops being kind.

Read aloud at the start of every session.

Slow Money · The Kitchen Table

Our ground rules



1. Nobody has to share numbers.
2. Gifts stay gifts.
3. Every age speaks. The youngest may ask anything; the oldest speaks first about the past.
4. What is said here stays here.
5. We stop when it stops being kind.

Read aloud at the start of every session.



A Kitchen Table is a family conversation about money, around a shared meal, with every generation present. The first one is not about fixing anything. It is about making the family's economy visible and hearing how each generation sees it.

You will need

- A meal and a table
- As many generations as you can gather (a grandparent on a call counts)
- About an hour
- The ground rules card (01) and question cards (03)
- A first chronicle page (05)

No bank statements, no spreadsheets, no figures.

Before the day

Tell everyone the meal will include a conversation about money, and that nobody will be asked to share numbers. Anyone can call a Kitchen Table, including a teenager.

On the day

1. **Welcome.** Start the meal. Read the ground rules aloud.
2. **Round one: memories.** The oldest person answers first. Pick one or two cards, not all.
3. **Round two: habits.** About this household. Anyone may start. Children use their own cards.
4. **Round three: hopes.** The youngest answers first.
5. **Closing.** Everyone names one thing they heard that surprised them.
6. **The chronicle.** One person writes a single line: the date, who was there, and one thing the family decided or wants to remember. Never figures, never who said what.
7. **Finish the meal.** The conversation is over when the table is cleared.

If it goes badly. Silence is allowed, and so is laughing. If the talk turns to blame or old grievances, pause and return to the meal. Try again another day with memories only. Where money is tied to serious conflict, outside help may be needed first.

Next: within a few weeks, a younger family member interviews an elder using sheet 04, Money Memories.



03

The Kitchen Table · page 1 of 2

Kitchen Table question cards

Cut along the dashed lines. Choose one or two cards per round, not all of them. Anyone may pass.

Round one · Memories

Oldest answers first

What did money mean in your home when you were a child?



Round one · Memories

Oldest answers first

What was the first money you ever earned, and what did you do with it?



Round one · Memories

Oldest answers first

What did your parents never talk about when it came to money?



Round one · Memories

Oldest answers first

Was there a time when money was very short? What did the family do?



Round one · Memories

Oldest answers first

What did your family trust to keep its savings safe?



Round two · Habits

Anyone may start

What do we do with money in this house that we have never talked about?



Round two · Habits

Anyone may start

Who decides how money is spent here? Who knows the most about it?



Round two · Habits

Anyone may start

When money comes into this house, where does it go first?





03

The Kitchen Table ·page 2 of 2

Kitchen Table question cards

Cut along the dashed lines. Choose one or two cards per round, not all of them. Anyone may pass.

Round two ·Habits

Anyone may start

What is one money habit you think you learned from someone at this table?



Round two ·For children

Anyone may start

Where do you think our money comes from?



Round two ·For children

Anyone may start

What do we spend the most money on?



Round two ·For children

Anyone may start

What would you do if someone gave you some money today?



Round three ·Hopes

Youngest answers first

What is one thing this family does with money that you want to keep?



Round three ·Hopes

Youngest answers first

What is one thing you would like us to do differently?



Round three ·Hopes

Youngest answers first

What do you hope this family will still have in thirty years?



Closing

Everyone

What is one thing you heard today that surprised you?





Money Memories interview sheet

A younger family member asks an older one what money meant in their life, and listens. Choose a handful of questions; one good story can fill the hour. Young children can ask three questions and be done.

Storyteller _____ Interviewer _____ Date _____

Before you begin, the storyteller decides. The interview will be kept as: ☐ notes ☐ a recording ☐ nothing

It may be shared beyond the family: ☐ yes ☐ yes, without names ☐ no. You can skip any question and stop at any time.

Growing up

- What did your parents do for work?
- Did people swap things or help each other instead of paying?

First work

- What was your first job? How were you paid, and how often?
- What did you do with your first wages?

Prices

- How much did a loaf of bread, a coffee or a bus ticket cost when you were young?
- What did a house cost, compared to a year's wages?

Then and now. Afterwards, compare one remembered price with today's.

	Then	Now
Item	_____	_____
Price	_____	_____
Hours of work to buy it	_____	_____



Hard times

- Was there a time when money was very short? What did your family do?
- Do you remember when the currency changed? What happened to people's savings?

Trust

- Where did your family keep its savings: at home, in a bank, in the post office, in gold, in land?
- Did anyone in the family ever lose money? How?

Debt

- Did your family ever borrow? Who from?
- Was debt thought of as normal, or as something shameful?

Looking back

- What is the best thing you ever did with money?
- What do you wish you had known about money when you were my age?

For the chronicle. Ask: what should this family never forget? Write one line to copy into the chronicle (sheet 05).

Tips for interviewers: listen more than you ask. "Tell me more about that" is often the best question. Don't correct or argue. If the storyteller becomes upset, stop, and let them decide whether to go on.



The Chronicle of the

family

Begun on

First keeper

This book records what our family decided about money, and why. It holds decisions and reasons: never sums, never grievances, never who said what. It is kept by hand and handed down.



05

The Family Ledger · entry page (print several)

Chronicle pages

Date _____ Present _____

What we decided, or want to remember

Why

Date _____ Present _____

What we decided, or want to remember

Why

Date _____ Present _____

What we decided, or want to remember

Why



06

After the pilot

Pilot feedback sheet

This pilot shapes the next version of Slow Money. Please answer as honestly as you like; criticism is the most useful thing you can give. No names are needed.

What did you try? ☐ Kitchen Table ☐ Money Memories ☐ The Test ☐ Retook Family Ledger module

Who took part? ☐ children ☐ teenagers ☐ adults ☐ elders **How long did it take?** _____

What worked best?

What felt awkward, too personal or confusing?

Which question would you change or remove? Which question is missing?

Did anyone want to stop? What happened?

Did anything change in how your family talks about money?

If you took The Test: did comparing Family Ledger answers lead anywhere? (No scores needed.)

Would you do it again? ☐ yes ☐ maybe ☐ no **Would you recommend it to another family?**

☐ yes ☐ no